One comparison structure, four institutional decisions

Hospital stars

CMS April 2026, methodology v5.1

Unit	Eligible acute-care hospital
Evidence	Mortality, safety, readmission; experience and timely care
Report	Stars within peer groups; patient-safety cap
Use / limit	Public information; benefit not established here

Clinical benefit–risk

Li et al. (2019), creatine reanalysis

Unit	Treatment alternatives for a specified patient
Evidence	Outcome predictions; proxy or simulated weights
Report	SMAA rank acceptability (method illustration)
Use / limit	Analytical decision aid; adoption not established

Spatial deprivation

England IMD25 / Pride in Place 2026

Unit	LSOA index units; MSOA allocation units
Evidence	Deprivation domains; community need in selection
Report	IMD25 ranks and deciles
Use / limit	Selection adds aggregation; cohesion + constituency cap

Employer report cards

KRW 2024; earlier audit data

Unit	Retained firms in the audit
Evidence	Race and gender contact gaps with EB uncertainty
Report	Separate criterion grades and posterior summaries
Use / limit	Public research disclosure; investigative uses proposed

Common fields do not imply common objectives, adoption, or effects.